

MATH 350-2 Advanced Calculus

W.R. Casper

Department of Mathematics
California State University Fullerton

November 17, 2025

Outline

- 1 Real Analysis Lecture 24
 - Riemann-Stieltjes integrals

Outline

- 1 Real Analysis Lecture 24
 - Riemann-Stieltjes integrals

Integrals

Back in Calculus, we learned about **integrals**.

Integrals

Back in Calculus, we learned about **integrals**.
It turns out that there are many types of integrals:

Integrals

Back in Calculus, we learned about **integrals**.
It turns out that there are many types of integrals:

- the Riemann integral (our familiar friend)

Integrals

Back in Calculus, we learned about **integrals**.
It turns out that there are many types of integrals:

- the Riemann integral (our familiar friend)
- the Riemann-Stieltjes integral

Integrals

Back in Calculus, we learned about **integrals**.

It turns out that there are many types of integrals:

- the Riemann integral (our familiar friend)
- the Riemann-Stieltjes integral
- the Lebesgue integral ...

Integrals

Back in Calculus, we learned about **integrals**.

It turns out that there are many types of integrals:

- the Riemann integral (our familiar friend)
- the Riemann-Stieltjes integral
- the Lebesgue integral ...

Most of these generalize the Riemann integral in some sense.

Partitions

Definition

A **partition** P of $[a, b]$ is a set of points

$$\{x_0, x_1, \dots, x_n\}$$

with

$$a = x_0 < x_1 < x_2 < \dots < x_n = b.$$

Partitions

Definition

A **partition** P of $[a, b]$ is a set of points

$$\{x_0, x_1, \dots, x_n\}$$

with

$$a = x_0 < x_1 < x_2 < \dots < x_n = b.$$

A set of **sample points** for P is a set $\{t_1, \dots, t_n\}$ with $t_k \in [x_{k-1}, x_k]$ for all $1 \leq k \leq n$.

Partitions

Definition

A **partition** P of $[a, b]$ is a set of points

$$\{x_0, x_1, \dots, x_n\}$$

with

$$a = x_0 < x_1 < x_2 < \dots < x_n = b.$$

A set of **sample points** for P is a set $\{t_1, \dots, t_n\}$ with $t_k \in [x_{k-1}, x_k]$ for all $1 \leq k \leq n$. A partition P' is a **refinement** of P if $P \subseteq P'$.

Challenge!

Problem

What is the smallest possible partition P of $[-2, 3]$? How many sample points will P need?

Challenge!

Problem

What is the smallest possible partition P of $[-2, 3]$? How many sample points will P need?

Problem

Give an example of some sample points of the partition $P = \{-2, -1, 0, 1, 2, 3\}$ of $[-2, 3]$. Can you find a refinement of the partition P ?

Challenge!

Problem

What is the smallest possible partition P of $[-2, 3]$? How many sample points will P need?

Problem

Give an example of some sample points of the partition $P = \{-2, -1, 0, 1, 2, 3\}$ of $[-2, 3]$. Can you find a refinement of the partition P ?

Problem

Can you find a refinement of the previous partition P ?

Riemann sums

Riemann sums on $[a, b]$

Riemann sums

Riemann sums on $[a, b]$

- right Riemann sum with n rectangles

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k) \Delta x, \quad x_k = a + k \Delta x, \quad \Delta x = (b - a)/n$$

Riemann sums

Riemann sums on $[a, b]$

- right Riemann sum with n rectangles

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k) \Delta x, \quad x_k = a + k \Delta x, \quad \Delta x = (b - a)/n$$

- left Riemann sum with n rectangles

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_{k-1}) \Delta x, \quad x_k = a + k \Delta x, \quad \Delta x = (b - a)/n$$

Riemann sums

Riemann sums on $[a, b]$

- right Riemann sum with n rectangles

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k) \Delta x, \quad x_k = a + k \Delta x, \quad \Delta x = (b - a)/n$$

- left Riemann sum with n rectangles

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_{k-1}) \Delta x, \quad x_k = a + k \Delta x, \quad \Delta x = (b - a)/n$$

- midpoint rule

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k^*) \Delta x, \quad x_k^* = a + (k + 1/2) \Delta x, \quad \Delta x = (b - a)/n$$

Riemann sums

Generalizations:

Riemann sums

Generalizations:

- generic sample points

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k^*) \Delta x, \quad x_k^* \in [a + (k-1)\Delta x, a + k\Delta x], \quad \Delta x = (b-a)/n$$

Riemann sums

Generalizations:

- generic sample points

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k^*) \Delta x, \quad x_k^* \in [a + (k-1)\Delta x, a + k\Delta x], \quad \Delta x = (b-a)/n$$

- not equally spaced rectangles

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k^*) (x_k - x_{k-1}), \quad x_k^* \in [x_{k-1}, x_k], \quad a = x_0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n = b$$

Riemann sums

Generalizations:

- generic sample points

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k^*) \Delta x, \quad x_k^* \in [a + (k-1)\Delta x, a + k\Delta x], \quad \Delta x = (b-a)/n$$

- not equally spaced rectangles

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k^*) (x_k - x_{k-1}), \quad x_k^* \in [x_{k-1}, x_k], \quad a = x_0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n = b$$

- weighted integral

$$\sum_{k=1}^n f(x_k^*) (\alpha(x_k) - \alpha(x_{k-1})), \quad x_k^* \in [x_{k-1}, x_k], \quad a = x_0 < x_1 < \cdots < x_n = b$$

Riemann-Stieltjes sums

Notation: given a real-valued function α on $[a, b]$

$$\Delta\alpha_k(P) = \alpha(x_k) - \alpha(x_{k-1}), \quad k = 1, 2, \dots, n.$$

Riemann-Stieltjes sums

Notation: given a real-valued function α on $[a, b]$

$$\Delta\alpha_k(P) = \alpha(x_k) - \alpha(x_{k-1}), \quad k = 1, 2, \dots, n.$$

Definition

Riemann-Stieltjes sums

Notation: given a real-valued function α on $[a, b]$

$$\Delta\alpha_k(P) = \alpha(x_k) - \alpha(x_{k-1}), \quad k = 1, 2, \dots, n.$$

Definition

Let f and α be real-valued functions on $[a, b]$, and let $P = \{x_0, x_1, \dots, x_n\}$ be a partition of $[a, b]$.

Riemann-Stieltjes sums

Notation: given a real-valued function α on $[a, b]$

$$\Delta\alpha_k(P) = \alpha(x_k) - \alpha(x_{k-1}), \quad k = 1, 2, \dots, n.$$

Definition

Let f and α be real-valued functions on $[a, b]$, and let $P = \{x_0, x_1, \dots, x_n\}$ be a partition of $[a, b]$. A sum of the form

$$S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) = \sum_{k=1}^n f(t_k) \Delta\alpha_k(P),$$

for some set of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P .

Riemann-Stieltjes integral

Definition

Riemann-Stieltjes integral

Definition

Let f and α be real-valued functions on $[a, b]$.

Riemann-Stieltjes integral

Definition

Let f and α be real-valued functions on $[a, b]$. We say f is **Riemann integrable** with respect to α on $[a, b]$ if there exists $A \in \mathbb{R}$ with the following property:

Riemann-Stieltjes integral

Definition

Let f and α be real-valued functions on $[a, b]$. We say f is **Riemann integrable** with respect to α on $[a, b]$ if there exists $A \in \mathbb{R}$ with the following property: for all $\epsilon > 0$, there exists a partition P_ϵ of $[a, b]$ such that for all refinements P of P_ϵ

$$|S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - A| < \epsilon,$$

for all sets of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P .

Riemann-Stieltjes integral

Definition

Let f and α be real-valued functions on $[a, b]$. We say f is **Riemann integrable** with respect to α on $[a, b]$ if there exists $A \in \mathbb{R}$ with the following property: for all $\epsilon > 0$, there exists a partition P_ϵ of $[a, b]$ such that for all refinements P of P_ϵ

$$|S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - A| < \epsilon,$$

for all sets of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P .

Notation: in this case A is denoted by $\int_a^b f d\alpha$ or $\int_a^b f(x) d\alpha(x)$

Challenge!

Problem

Suppose that a, b are real numbers with $a < b$ and let α be a real-valued function on $[a, b]$.

Prove that a constant function $f(x) = c$ is integrable with respect to α on $[a, b]$ and

$$\int_a^b f d\alpha = c\alpha(b) - c\alpha(a).$$

Challenge!

Problem

Suppose that a, b are real numbers with $a < b$ and let α be a constant function on $a < b$.

If $f(x)$ is a function on $[a, b]$, show that $f(x)$ is integrable with respect to α on $[a, b]$.

What is $\int_a^b f d\alpha$?

Challenge!

Problem

Suppose that a, b, c are real numbers with $a < c < b$ and let α be the step function

$$\alpha(x) = \begin{cases} 0, & x < c \\ 1, & x \geq c \end{cases}$$

Show that if $f(x)$ is a real function on $[a, b]$ which is continuous at c , then f is integrable with respect to α on $[a, b]$.

What is $\int_a^b f d\alpha$?

Linearity of integration

Theorem

Suppose that f and g are Riemann integrable with respect to α on $[a, b]$.

Linearity of integration

Theorem

Suppose that f and g are Riemann integrable with respect to α on $[a, b]$.

Then for any $c_1, c_2 \in \mathbb{R}$, $c_1 f + c_2 g$ is Riemann integrable with respect to α and

$$\int_a^b (c_1 f + c_2 g) d\alpha = c_1 \int_a^b f d\alpha + c_2 \int_a^b g d\alpha.$$

Linearity of integration

Proof.

Linearity of integration

Proof.

Let $\epsilon > 0$ and WLOG assume $c_1, c_2 \neq 0$.

Linearity of integration

Proof.

Let $\epsilon > 0$ and WLOG assume $c_1, c_2 \neq 0$.

Choose a partition P'_ϵ such that

$$|S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b f d\alpha| < \epsilon/2|c_1|,$$

for all refinements P of P'_ϵ and sets of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P .

Linearity of integration

Proof.

Let $\epsilon > 0$ and WLOG assume $c_1, c_2 \neq 0$.

Choose a partition P'_ϵ such that

$$|S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b f d\alpha| < \epsilon/2|c_1|,$$

for all refinements P of P'_ϵ and sets of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P .

Also, choose a partition P''_ϵ such that

$$|S(P, g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b g d\alpha| < \epsilon/2|c_2|,$$

for all refinements P of P''_ϵ and sets of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P .

Linearity of integration

Proof.

Let $\epsilon > 0$ and WLOG assume $c_1, c_2 \neq 0$.

Choose a partition P'_ϵ such that

$$|S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b f d\alpha| < \epsilon/2 |c_1|,$$

for all refinements P of P'_ϵ and sets of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P .
Also, choose a partition P''_ϵ such that

$$|S(P, g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b g d\alpha| < \epsilon/2 |c_2|,$$

for all refinements P of P''_ϵ and sets of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P .
Let $P_\epsilon = P'_\epsilon \cup P''_\epsilon$.

Linearity of integration

Proof.

Let $\epsilon > 0$ and WLOG assume $c_1, c_2 \neq 0$.

Choose a partition P'_ϵ such that

$$|S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b f d\alpha| < \epsilon/2|c_1|,$$

for all refinements P of P'_ϵ and sets of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P . Also, choose a partition P''_ϵ such that

$$|S(P, g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b g d\alpha| < \epsilon/2|c_2|,$$

for all refinements P of P''_ϵ and sets of sample points $\{t_k\}$ of P . Let $P_\epsilon = P'_\epsilon \cup P''_\epsilon$. Then any refinement P of P_ϵ , is a refinement of P'_ϵ and P''_ϵ . □

Linearity of integration

Proof.

Therefore if P is a refinement of P_ϵ , and $\{t_k\}$ is a set of sample points of P , then by the triangle inequality

Linearity of integration

Proof.

Therefore if P is a refinement of P_ϵ , and $\{t_k\}$ is a set of sample points of P , then by the triangle inequality

$$\begin{aligned} & |S(P, c_1 f + c_2 g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - (c_1 \int_a^b f d\alpha + c_2 \int_a^b g d\alpha)| \\ &= |c_1 S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) + c_2 S(P, g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - (c_1 \int_a^b f d\alpha + c_2 \int_a^b g d\alpha)| \\ &= |c_1 S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - c_1 \int_a^b f d\alpha + c_2 S(P, g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - c_2 \int_a^b g d\alpha| \\ &\leq |c_1| \cdot |S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b f d\alpha| + |c_2| \cdot |S(P, g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b g d\alpha| \\ &\qquad\qquad\qquad < \epsilon/2 + \epsilon/2 = \epsilon. \end{aligned}$$

Linearity of integration

Proof.

Therefore if P is a refinement of P_ϵ , and $\{t_k\}$ is a set of sample points of P , then by the triangle inequality

$$\begin{aligned}
 & |S(P, c_1 f + c_2 g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - (c_1 \int_a^b f d\alpha + c_2 \int_a^b g d\alpha)| \\
 &= |c_1 S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) + c_2 S(P, g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - (c_1 \int_a^b f d\alpha + c_2 \int_a^b g d\alpha)| \\
 &= |c_1 S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - c_1 \int_a^b f d\alpha + c_2 S(P, g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - c_2 \int_a^b g d\alpha| \\
 &\leq |c_1| \cdot |S(P, f, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b f d\alpha| + |c_2| \cdot |S(P, g, \alpha, \{t_k\}) - \int_a^b g d\alpha| \\
 &\qquad\qquad\qquad < \epsilon/2 + \epsilon/2 = \epsilon.
 \end{aligned}$$

Since $\epsilon > 0$ was arbitrary, this proves the theorem. □ ↻ 🔍

Linearity of integration

Theorem

Suppose that f is Riemann integrable with respect to both α and β on $[a, b]$.

Linearity of integration

Theorem

Suppose that f is Riemann integrable with respect to both α and β on $[a, b]$.

Then for any $c_1, c_2 \in \mathbb{R}$, f is Riemann integrable with respect to $c_1\alpha + c_2\beta$ and

$$\int_a^b f d(c_1\alpha + c_2\beta) = c_1 \int_a^b f d\alpha + c_2 \int_a^b f d\beta.$$

Challenge!

Problem

Prove the last theorem!

Linearity of integration

Theorem

Suppose that f is a real-valued function on $[a, b]$ and that $c \in (a, b)$.

Linearity of integration

Theorem

Suppose that f is a real-valued function on $[a, b]$ and that $c \in (a, b)$. If $\int_a^c f d\alpha$ and $\int_c^b f d\alpha$ exist, then $\int_a^b f d\alpha$ exists and

$$\int_a^c f d\alpha + \int_c^b f d\alpha = \int_a^b f d\alpha.$$

Linearity of integration

Theorem

Suppose that f is a real-valued function on $[a, b]$ and that $c \in (a, b)$. If $\int_a^c f d\alpha$ and $\int_b^c f d\alpha$ exist, then $\int_a^b f d\alpha$ exists and

$$\int_a^c f d\alpha + \int_c^b f d\alpha = \int_a^b f d\alpha.$$

Conversely, if $\int_a^b f d\alpha$ exists then $\int_a^c f d\alpha$ and $\int_b^c f d\alpha$ exist and

$$\int_a^c f d\alpha + \int_c^b f d\alpha = \int_a^b f d\alpha.$$

Integration by parts

The integrand and integrator play dual roles:

Theorem

Integration by parts Let f be integrable with respect to α on $[a, b]$.

Then α is integrable with respect to f on $[a, b]$ and

$$\int_a^b f d\alpha = f(b)\alpha(b) - f(a)\alpha(a) - \int_a^b \alpha df.$$

Relation to Riemann integrals

Theorem

Let f be integrable with respect to α on $[a, b]$.

If α is continuous on $[a, b]$ and continuously differentiable on (a, b) , then $f(x)\alpha'(x)$ is integrable with respect to x on $[a, b]$ and

$$\int_a^b f d\alpha = \int_a^b f(x)\alpha'(x) dx.$$